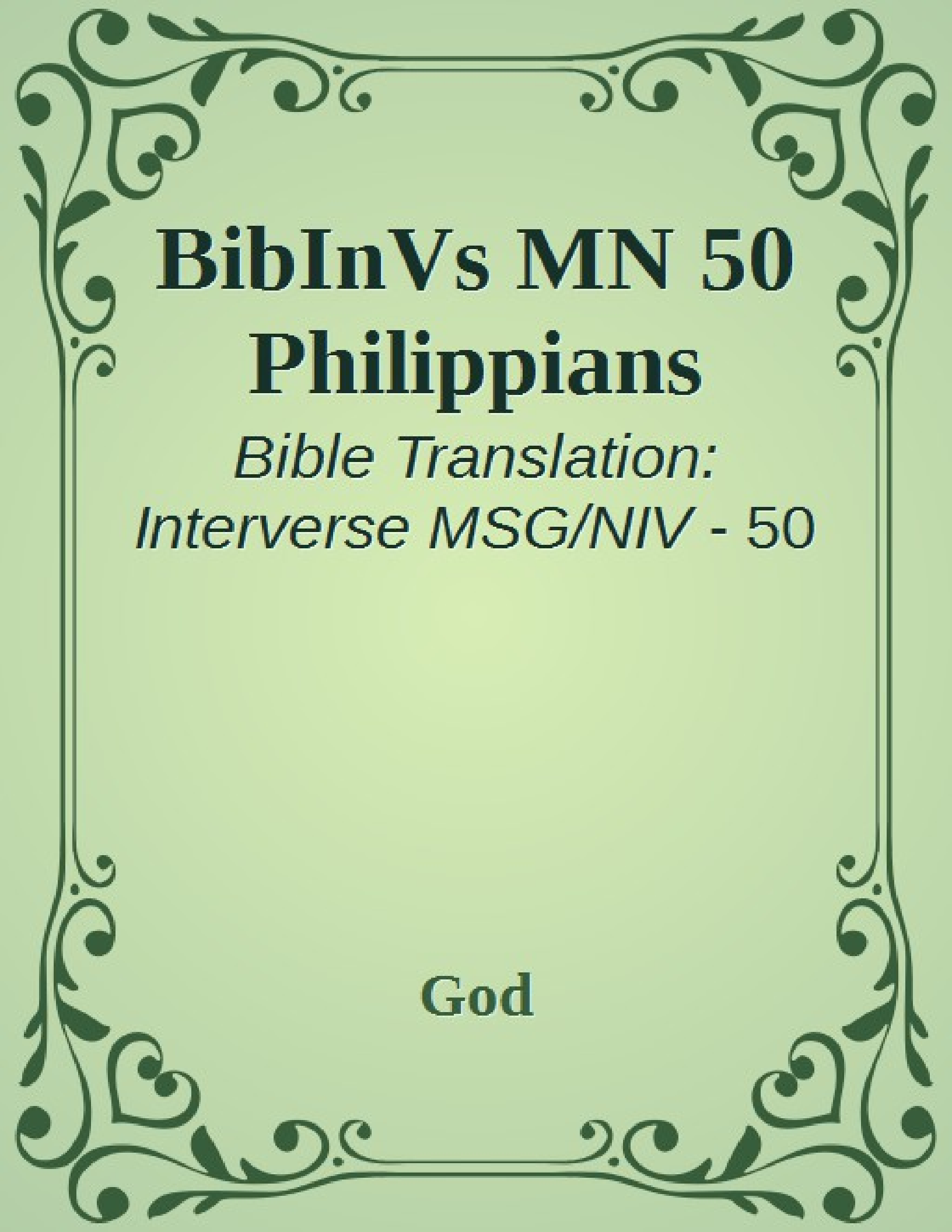


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 50

Philippians

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 50*

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Philippians

Philippians 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 Paul and Timothy, both of us committed servants of Christ Jesus, write this letter to all the Christians in Philippi, pastors and ministers included.
- 1 Paul and Timothy, servants of Christ Jesus, To all the saints in Christ Jesus at Philippi, together with the overseers and deacons:
- 2 We greet you with the grace and peace that comes from God our Father and our Master, Jesus Christ.
- 2 Grace and peace to you from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.
- 3 Every time you cross my mind, I break out in exclamations of thanks to God.
- 3 I thank my God every time I remember you.
- 4 Each exclamation is a trigger to prayer. I find myself praying for you with a glad heart.
- 4 In all my prayers for all of you, I always pray with joy
- 5 I am so pleased that you have continued on in this with us, believing and proclaiming God's Message, from the day you heard it right up to the present.
- 5 because of your partnership in the gospel from the first day until now,
- 6 There has never been the slightest doubt in my mind that the God who started this great work in you would keep at it and bring it to a flourishing finish on the very day Christ Jesus appears.
- 6 being confident of this, that he who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus.
- 7 It's not at all fanciful for me to think this way about you. My prayers and hopes have deep roots in reality. You have, after all, stuck with me all the way from the time I was thrown in jail, put on trial, and came out of it in one piece. All along you have experienced with me the most generous help from God.

- 7 It is right for me to feel this way about all of you, since I have you in my heart; for whether I am in chains or defending and confirming the gospel, all of you share in God's grace with me.
- 8 He knows how much I love and miss you these days. Sometimes I think I feel as strongly about you as Christ does!
- 8 God can testify how I long for all of you with the affection of Christ Jesus.
- 9 So this is my prayer: that your love will flourish and that you will not only love much but well. Learn to love appropriately. You need to use your head and test your feelings
- 9 And this is my prayer: that your love may abound more and more in knowledge and depth of insight,
- 10 so that your love is sincere and intelligent, not sentimental gush. Live a lover's life, circumspect and exemplary, a life Jesus will be proud of:
- 10 so that you may be able to discern what is best and may be pure and blameless until the day of Christ,
- 11 bountiful in fruits from the soul, making Jesus Christ attractive to all, getting everyone involved in the glory and praise of God.
- 11 filled with the fruit of righteousness that comes through Jesus Christ--to the glory and praise of God.
- 12 I want to report to you, friends, that my imprisonment here has had the opposite of its intended effect. Instead of being squelched, the Message has actually prospered.
- 12 Now I want you to know, brothers, that what has happened to me has really served to advance the gospel.
- 13 All the soldiers here, and everyone else too, found out that I'm in jail because of this Messiah. That piqued their curiosity, and now they've learned all about him.
- 13 As a result, it has become clear throughout the whole palace guard and to everyone else that I am in chains for Christ.
- 14 Not only that, but most of the Christians here have become far more sure of themselves in the faith than ever, speaking out fearlessly about God, about the Messiah.
- 14 Because of my chains, most of the brothers in the Lord have been encouraged to speak the word of God more courageously and fearlessly.

- 15 It's true that some here preach Christ because with me out of the way, they think they'll step right into the spotlight. But the others do it with the best heart in the world.
- 15 It is true that some preach Christ out of envy and rivalry, but others out of goodwill.
- 16 One group is motivated by pure love, knowing that I am here defending the Message, wanting to help.
- 16 The latter do so in love, knowing that I am put here for the defense of the gospel.
- 17 The others, now that I'm out of the picture, are merely greedy, hoping to get something out of it for themselves. Their motives are bad. They see me as their competition, and so the worse it goes for me, the better--they think--for them.
- 17 The former preach Christ out of selfish ambition, not sincerely, supposing that they can stir up trouble for me while I am in chains.
- 18 So how am I to respond? I've decided that I really don't care about their motives, whether mixed, bad, or indifferent. Every time one of them opens his mouth, Christ is proclaimed, so I just cheer them on! And I'm going to keep that celebration going
- 18 But what does it matter? The important thing is that in every way, whether from false motives or true, Christ is preached. And because of this I rejoice. Yes, and I will continue to rejoice,
- 19 because I know how it's going to turn out. Through your faithful prayers and the generous response of the Spirit of Jesus Christ, everything he wants to do in and through me will be done.
- 19 for I know that through your prayers and the help given by the Spirit of Jesus Christ, what has happened to me will turn out for my deliverance.
- 20 I can hardly wait to continue on my course. I don't expect to be embarrassed in the least. On the contrary, everything happening to me in this jail only serves to make Christ more accurately known, regardless of whether I live or die. They didn't shut me up; they gave me a pulpit!
- 20 I eagerly expect and hope that I will in no way be ashamed, but will have sufficient courage so that now as always Christ will be exalted in my body, whether by life or by death.
- 21 Alive, I'm Christ's messenger; dead, I'm his bounty. Life versus even more life! I can't lose.

21 For to me, to live is Christ and to die is gain.

22 As long as I'm alive in this body, there is good work for me to do. If I had to choose right now, I hardly know which I'd choose.

22 If I am to go on living in the body, this will mean fruitful labor for me. Yet what shall I choose? I do not know!

23 Hard choice! The desire to break camp here and be with Christ is powerful. Some days I can think of nothing better

23 I am torn between the two: I desire to depart and be with Christ, which is better by far;

24 . But most days, because of what you are going through, I am sure that it's better for me to stick it out here.

24 but it is more necessary for you that I remain in the body.

25 So I plan to be around awhile, companion to you as your growth and joy in this life of trusting God continues.

25 Convinced of this, I know that I will remain, and I will continue with all of you for your progress and joy in the faith,

26 You can start looking forward to a great reunion when I come visit you again. We'll be praising Christ, enjoying each other.

26 so that through my being with you again your joy in Christ Jesus will overflow on account of me.

27 Meanwhile, live in such a way that you are a credit to the Message of Christ. Let nothing in your conduct hang on whether I come or not. Your conduct must be the same whether I show up to see things for myself or hear of it from a distance. Stand united, singular in vision, contending for people's trust in the Message, the good news,

27 Whatever happens, conduct yourselves in a manner worthy of the gospel of Christ. Then, whether I come and see you or only hear about you in my absence, I will know that you stand firm in one spirit, contending as one man for the faith of the gospel

28 not flinching or dodging in the slightest before the opposition. Your courage and unity will show them what they're up against: defeat for them, victory for you--and both because of God.

28 without being frightened in any way by those who oppose you. This is a sign to them that they will be destroyed, but that you will be saved--and that by God.

- 29 There's far more to this life than trusting in Christ. There's also suffering for him. And the suffering is as much a gift as the trusting.
- 29 For it has been granted to you on behalf of Christ not only to believe on him, but also to suffer for him,
- 30 You're involved in the same kind of struggle you saw me go through, on which you are now getting an updated report in this letter.
- 30 since you are going through the same struggle you saw I had, and now hear that I still have.

Philippians 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 If you've gotten anything at all out of following Christ, if his love has made any difference in your life, if being in a community of the Spirit means anything to you, if you have a heart, if you care--
- 1 If you have any encouragement from being united with Christ, if any comfort from his love, if any fellowship with the Spirit, if any tenderness and compassion,
- 2 then do me a favor: Agree with each other, love each other, be deep-spirited friends.
- 2 then make my joy complete by being like-minded, having the same love, being one in spirit and purpose.
- 3 Don't push your way to the front; don't sweet-talk your way to the top. Put yourself aside, and help others get ahead.
- 3 Do nothing out of selfish ambition or vain conceit, but in humility consider others better than yourselves.
- 4 Don't be obsessed with getting your own advantage. Forget yourselves long enough to lend a helping hand.
- 4 Each of you should look not only to your own interests, but also to the interests of others.
- 5 Think of yourselves the way Christ Jesus thought of himself.
- 5 Your attitude should be the same as that of Christ Jesus:
- 6 He had equal status with God but didn't think so much of himself that he had to cling to the advantages of that status no matter what.

- 6 Who, being in very nature God, did not consider equality with God something to be grasped,
- 7 Not at all. When the time came, he set aside the privileges of deity and took on the status of a slave, became human!
- 7 but made himself nothing, taking the very nature of a servant, being made in human likeness.
- 8 Having become human, he stayed human. It was an incredibly humbling process. He didn't claim special privileges. Instead, he lived a selfless, obedient life and then died a selfless, obedient death--and the worst kind of death at that: a crucifixion.
- 8 And being found in appearance as a man, he humbled himself and became obedient to death-- even death on a cross!
- 9 Because of that obedience, God lifted him high and honored him far beyond anyone or anything, ever,
- 9 Therefore God exalted him to the highest place and gave him the name that is above every name,
- 10 so that all created beings in heaven and on earth--even those long ago dead and buried--will bow in worship before this Jesus Christ,
- 10 that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth,
- 11 and call out in praise that he is the Master of all, to the glorious honor of God the Father.
- 11 and every tongue confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father.
- 12 What I'm getting at, friends, is that you should simply keep on doing what you've done from the beginning. When I was living among you, you lived in responsive obedience. Now that I'm separated from you, keep it up. Better yet, redouble your efforts. Be energetic in your life of salvation, reverent and sensitive before God.
- 12 Therefore, my dear friends, as you have always obeyed-- not only in my presence, but now much more in my absence--continue to work out your salvation with fear and trembling,
- 13 That energy is God's energy, an energy deep within you, God himself willing and working at what will give him the most pleasure.
- 13 for it is God who works in you to will and to act according to his good purpose.

- 14 Do everything readily and cheerfully--no bickering, no second-guessing allowed!
- 14 Do everything without complaining or arguing,
- 15 Go out into the world uncorrupted, a breath of fresh air in this squalid and polluted society. Provide people with a glimpse of good living and of the living God. Carry the light-giving Message into the night
- 15 so that you may become blameless and pure, children of God without fault in a crooked and depraved generation, in which you shine like stars in the universe
- 16 so I'll have good cause to be proud of you on the day that Christ returns. You'll be living proof that I didn't go to all this work for nothing.
- 16 as you hold out the word of life--in order that I may boast on the day of Christ that I did not run or labor for nothing.
- 17 Even if I am executed here and now, I'll rejoice in being an element in the offering of your faith that you make on Christ's altar, a part of your rejoicing.
- 17 But even if I am being poured out like a drink offering on the sacrifice and service coming from your faith, I am glad and rejoice with all of you.
- 18 But turnabout's fair play--you must join me in my rejoicing. Whatever you do, don't feel sorry for me.
- 18 So you too should be glad and rejoice with me.
- 19 I plan (according to Jesus' plan) to send Timothy to you very soon so he can bring back all the news of you he can gather. Oh, how that will do my heart good!
- 19 I hope in the Lord Jesus to send Timothy to you soon, that I also may be cheered when I receive news about you.
- 20 I have no one quite like Timothy. He is loyal, and genuinely concerned for you.
- 20 I have no one else like him, who takes a genuine interest in your welfare.
- 21 Most people around here are looking out for themselves, with little concern for the things of Jesus.
- 21 For everyone looks out for his own interests, not those of Jesus Christ.
- 22 But you know yourselves that Timothy's the real thing. He's been a devoted son to me as together we've delivered the Message.

- 22 But you know that Timothy has proved himself, because as a son with his father he has served with me in the work of the gospel.
- 23 As soon as I see how things are going to fall out for me here, I plan to send him off.
- 23 I hope, therefore, to send him as soon as I see how things go with me.
- 24 And then I'm hoping and praying to be right on his heels.
- 24 And I am confident in the Lord that I myself will come soon.
- 25 But for right now, I'm dispatching Epaphroditus, my good friend and companion in my work. You sent him to help me out; now I'm sending him to help you out.
- 25 But I think it is necessary to send back to you Epaphroditus, my brother, fellow worker and fellow soldier, who is also your messenger, whom you sent to take care of my needs.
- 26 He has been wanting in the worst way to get back with you. Especially since recovering from the illness you heard about, he's been wanting to get back and reassure you that he is just fine.
- 26 For he longs for all of you and is distressed because you heard he was ill.
- 27 He nearly died, as you know, but God had mercy on him. And not only on him--he had mercy on me, too. His death would have been one huge grief piled on top of all the others.
- 27 Indeed he was ill, and almost died. But God had mercy on him, and not on him only but also on me, to spare me sorrow upon sorrow.
- 28 So you can see why I'm so delighted to send him on to you. When you see him again, hale and hearty, how you'll rejoice and how relieved I'll be.
- 28 Therefore I am all the more eager to send him, so that when you see him again you may be glad and I may have less anxiety.
- 29 Give him a grand welcome, a joyful embrace! People like him deserve the best you can give.
- 29 Welcome him in the Lord with great joy, and honor men like him,
- 30 Remember the ministry to me that you started but weren't able to complete? Well, in the process of finishing up that work, he put his life on the line and nearly died doing it.
- 30 because he almost died for the work of Christ, risking his life to make up for the help you could not give me.

Philippians 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 And that's about it, friends. Be glad in God! I don't mind repeating what I have written in earlier letters, and I hope you don't mind hearing it again. Better safe than sorry--so here goes.
- 1 Finally, my brothers, rejoice in the Lord! It is no trouble for me to write the same things to you again, and it is a safeguard for you.
- 2 Steer clear of the barking dogs, those religious busybodies, all bark and no bite. All they're interested in is appearances--knife-happy circumcisers, I call them.
- 2 Watch out for those dogs, those men who do evil, those mutilators of the flesh.
- 3 The real believers are the ones the Spirit of God leads to work away at this ministry, filling the air with Christ's praise as we do it. We couldn't carry this off by our own efforts, and we know it--
- 3 For it is we who are the circumcision, we who worship by the Spirit of God, who glory in Christ Jesus, and who put no confidence in the flesh--
- 4 even though we can list what many might think are impressive credentials. You know my pedigree:
- 4 though I myself have reasons for such confidence. If anyone else thinks he has reasons to put confidence in the flesh, I have more:
- 5 a legitimate birth, circumcised on the eighth day; an Israelite from the elite tribe of Benjamin; a strict and devout adherent to God's law;
- 5 circumcised on the eighth day, of the people of Israel, of the tribe of Benjamin, a Hebrew of Hebrews; in regard to the law, a Pharisee;
- 6 a fiery defender of the purity of my religion, even to the point of persecuting Christians; a meticulous observer of everything set down in God's law Book.
- 6 as for zeal, persecuting the church; as for legalistic righteousness, faultless.
- 7 The very credentials these people are waving around as something special, I'm tearing up and throwing out with the trash--along with everything else I used to take credit for. And why? Because of Christ.
- 7 But whatever was to my profit I now consider loss for the sake of Christ.

- 8 Yes, all the things I once thought were so important are gone from my life. Compared to the high privilege of knowing Christ Jesus as my Master, firsthand, everything I once thought I had going for me is insignificant--dog dung. I've dumped it all in the trash so that I could embrace Christ
- 8 What is more, I consider everything a loss compared to the surpassing greatness of knowing Christ Jesus my Lord, for whose sake I have lost all things. I consider them rubbish, that I may gain Christ
- 9 and be embraced by him. I didn't want some petty, inferior brand of righteousness that comes from keeping a list of rules when I could get the robust kind that comes from trusting Christ--God's righteousness.
- 9 and be found in him, not having a righteousness of my own that comes from the law, but that which is through faith in Christ-- the righteousness that comes from God and is by faith.
- 10 I gave up all that inferior stuff so I could know Christ personally, experience his resurrection power, be a partner in his suffering, and go all the way with him to death itself.
- 10 I want to know Christ and the power of his resurrection and the fellowship of sharing in his sufferings, becoming like him in his death,
- 11 If there was any way to get in on the resurrection from the dead, I wanted to do it.
- 11 and so, somehow, to attain to the resurrection from the dead.
- 12 I'm not saying that I have this all together, that I have it made. But I am well on my way, reaching out for Christ, who has so wondrously reached out for me.
- 12 Not that I have already obtained all this, or have already been made perfect, but I press on to take hold of that for which Christ Jesus took hold of me.
- 13 Friends, don't get me wrong: By no means do I count myself an expert in all of this, but I've got my eye on the goal, where God is beckoning us onward--to Jesus.
- 13 Brothers, I do not consider myself yet to have taken hold of it. But one thing I do: Forgetting what is behind and straining toward what is ahead,
- 14 I'm off and running, and I'm not turning back.
- 14 I press on toward the goal to win the prize for which God has called me heavenward in Christ Jesus.

- 15 So let's keep focused on that goal, those of us who want everything God has for us. If any of you have something else in mind, something less than total commitment, God will clear your blurred vision--you'll see it yet!
- 15 All of us who are mature should take such a view of things. And if on some point you think differently, that too God will make clear to you.
- 16 Now that we're on the right track, let's stay on it.
- 16 Only let us live up to what we have already attained.
- 17 Stick with me, friends. Keep track of those you see running this same course, headed for this same goal.
- 17 Join with others in following my example, brothers, and take note of those who live according to the pattern we gave you.
- 18 There are many out there taking other paths, choosing other goals, and trying to get you to go along with them. I've warned you of them many times; sadly, I'm having to do it again. All they want is easy street. They hate Christ's Cross.
- 18 For, as I have often told you before and now say again even with tears, many live as enemies of the cross of Christ.
- 19 But easy street is a dead-end street. Those who live there make their bellies their gods; belches are their praise; all they can think of is their appetites.
- 19 Their destiny is destruction, their god is their stomach, and their glory is in their shame. Their mind is on earthly things.
- 20 But there's far more to life for us. We're citizens of high heaven! We're waiting the arrival of the Savior, the Master, Jesus Christ,
- 20 But our citizenship is in heaven. And we eagerly await a Savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ,
- 21 who will transform our earthy bodies into glorious bodies like his own. He'll make us beautiful and whole with the same powerful skill by which he is putting everything as it should be, under and around him.
- 21 who, by the power that enables him to bring everything under his control, will transform our lowly bodies so that they will be like his glorious body.

Philippians 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 My dear, dear friends! I love you so much. I do want the very best for you. You make me feel such joy, fill me with such pride. Don't waver. Stay on track, steady in God.
- 1 Therefore, my brothers, you whom I love and long for, my joy and crown, that is how you should stand firm in the Lord, dear friends!
- 2 I urge Euodia and Syntyche to iron out their differences and make up. God doesn't want his children holding grudges.
- 2 I plead with Euodia and I plead with Syntyche to agree with each other in the Lord.
- 3 And, oh, yes, Syzygus, since you're right there to help them work things out, do your best with them. These women worked for the Message hand in hand with Clement and me, and with the other veterans--worked as hard as any of us. Remember, their names are also in the book of life.
- 3 Yes, and I ask you, loyal yokefellow, help these women who have contended at my side in the cause of the gospel, along with Clement and the rest of my fellow workers, whose names are in the book of life.
- 4 Celebrate God all day, every day. I mean, revel in him!
- 4 Rejoice in the Lord always. I will say it again: Rejoice!
- 5 Make it as clear as you can to all you meet that you're on their side, working with them and not against them. Help them see that the Master is about to arrive. He could show up any minute!
- 5 Let your gentleness be evident to all. The Lord is near.
- 6 Don't fret or worry. Instead of worrying, pray. Let petitions and praises shape your worries into prayers, letting God know your concerns.
- 6 Do not be anxious about anything, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God.
- 7 Before you know it, a sense of God's wholeness, everything coming together for good, will come and settle you down. It's wonderful what happens when Christ displaces worry at the center of your life.
- 7 And the peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.
- 8 Summing it all up, friends, I'd say you'll do best by filling your minds and meditating on things true, noble, reputable, authentic, compelling,

- gracious--the best, not the worst; the beautiful, not the ugly; things to praise, not things to curse.
- 8 Finally, brothers, whatever is true, whatever is noble, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable--if anything is excellent or praiseworthy--think about such things.
- 9 Put into practice what you learned from me, what you heard and saw and realized. Do that, and God, who makes everything work together, will work you into his most excellent harmonies.
- 9 Whatever you have learned or received or heard from me, or seen in me--put it into practice. And the God of peace will be with you.
- 10 I'm glad in God, far happier than you would ever guess--happy that you're again showing such strong concern for me. Not that you ever quit praying and thinking about me. You just had no chance to show it.
- 10 I rejoice greatly in the Lord that at last you have renewed your concern for me. Indeed, you have been concerned, but you had no opportunity to show it.
- 11 Actually, I don't have a sense of needing anything personally. I've learned by now to be quite content whatever my circumstances.
- 11 I am not saying this because I am in need, for I have learned to be content whatever the circumstances.
- 12 I'm just as happy with little as with much, with much as with little. I've found the recipe for being happy whether full or hungry, hands full or hands empty.
- 12 I know what it is to be in need, and I know what it is to have plenty. I have learned the secret of being content in any and every situation, whether well fed or hungry, whether living in plenty or in want.
- 13 Whatever I have, wherever I am, I can make it through anything in the One who makes me who I am.
- 13 I can do everything through him who gives me strength.
- 14 I don't mean that your help didn't mean a lot to me--it did. It was a beautiful thing that you came alongside me in my troubles.
- 14 Yet it was good of you to share in my troubles.
- 15 You Philippians well know, and you can be sure I'll never forget it, that when I first left Macedonia province, venturing out with the Message, not one church helped out in the give-and-take of this work except you. You were the only one.

- 15 Moreover, as you Philippians know, in the early days of your acquaintance with the gospel, when I set out from Macedonia, not one church shared with me in the matter of giving and receiving, except you only;
- 16 Even while I was in Thessalonica, you helped out--and not only once, but twice.
- 16 for even when I was in Thessalonica, you sent me aid again and again when I was in need.
- 17 Not that I'm looking for handouts, but I do want you to experience the blessing that issues from generosity.
- 17 Not that I am looking for a gift, but I am looking for what may be credited to your account.
- 18 And now I have it all--and keep getting more! The gifts you sent with Epaphroditus were more than enough, like a sweet-smelling sacrifice roasting on the altar, filling the air with fragrance, pleasing God no end.
- 18 I have received full payment and even more; I am amply supplied, now that I have received from Epaphroditus the gifts you sent. They are a fragrant offering, an acceptable sacrifice, pleasing to God.
- 19 You can be sure that God will take care of everything you need, his generosity exceeding even yours in the glory that pours from Jesus.
- 19 And my God will meet all your needs according to his glorious riches in Christ Jesus.
- 20 Our God and Father abounds in glory that just pours out into eternity. Yes.
- 20 To our God and Father be glory for ever and ever. Amen.
- 21 Give our regards to every Christian you meet. Our friends here say hello.
- 21 Greet all the saints in Christ Jesus. The brothers who are with me send greetings.
- 22 All the Christians here, especially the believers who work in the palace of Caesar, want to be remembered to you.
- 22 All the saints send you greetings, especially those who belong to Caesar's household.
- 23 Receive and experience the amazing grace of the Master, Jesus Christ, deep, deep within yourselves.
- 23 The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit. Amen.

